Ethiopian logistics teams run on spreadsheets, phone calls and guesswork.

1 · The problem

An Ethiopian freight and distribution operator plans routes in Excel, learns about a delayed truck by phone, and discovers a stock-out only when a customer complains. Four failures repeat daily:

- **Routes are planned by habit.** No repeatable way to weigh distance, time, cost and vehicle capacity.
- **Exceptions arrive too late.** Delays and low stock surface after the money is lost.
- **Cash is reconciled by hand.** Bank-transfer receipts are matched to invoices manually, and reversals leave no audit trail.
- **Data lives in files.** Warehouses, items, fleet and orders sit in disconnected CSVs nobody trusts.

The result: avoidable cost on every trip, and no single view an owner can act on.

EVIDENCE IT IS REAL

Built against the operating reality of Ethiopian operators: CBE and Dashen transfer receipts (5,000–50,000 ETB), Addis Ababa warehouse geography, and 3G-grade connections — not a Western SaaS template with the currency swapped.

2 · The solution

FreightPilot is one operator surface that takes a logistics team from signup to a planned, monitored, reconciled day of operations.

01	02	03	04	05
Onboard	**Import**	**Optimize**	**Monitor**	**Reconcile**
Company workspace in one form.	Warehouses, items, fleet, inventory, orders by CSV.	Weighted route plans on real geography.	Live feed, alerts, exception queue.	Receipts, wallet and audit trail.

Every screen is role-governed and scoped to one company, so an operator sees their own operation and nothing else.

81
live API endpoints

4
surfaces: web, console, API, desktop

19
schema migrations

3 · MARKET OPPORTUNITY

A large, underserved operator base that is already digitising — just not with software built for it.

Who we sell to

- **Primary:** Ethiopian freight forwarders, distributors and 3PL operators running 5–50 vehicles and 1–10 warehouses.
- **Buyer:** the owner or operations manager — one person who feels route cost, stock-outs and cash reconciliation every week.
- **Users per account:** 3–25 (dispatchers, warehouse operators, finance, owners).

Why now

- **Digital payments reached operational scale.** Bank-transfer receipts are now the normal settlement path, which makes receipt-to-invoice reconciliation a real software problem.
- **Smartphone and 3G coverage is good enough** for a browser console — no desktop install required to start.
- **Incumbents are priced and shaped for other markets.** Global TMS products assume carrier settlement breadth and English-first workflows that a 20-truck operator cannot absorb.

Market shape (bottom-up)

We deliberately do not quote a top-down TAM. The serviceable entry market is countable:

Serviceable operators Ethiopian freight / distribution / 3PL firms with a real fleet	**Low thousands**
Target ACV Mid tier, per workspace per year	**Recurring, ETB-priced**
Expansion path Adjacent East African corridors with the same receipt-and-cashflow reality	**Same product, new currency**

This is a **wedge into a regional logistics-software market**, not a bet on a single national market: the hard parts we have built (multi-tenant scoping, receipt reconciliation, route optimisation on local geography) transfer directly.

HONEST FRAMING

We are pre-revenue with a working product. This slide states the market we can *count* and how we reach it — not a fabricated market-size number.

4 · TRACTION · 5 · BUSINESS MODEL

A production platform, verified end to end — and a business model wired into the product.

399
backend tests passing on the locked dependency set

143 + 62
console + website tests passing

22/22
launch-funnel steps verified end to end

0
known vulnerabilities in the deployed dependency set

Traction — what is actually built and proven

- **Signup to first route plan works.** Verified: workspace created, sample data seeded, first optimisation returned a real plan — **21.07 km, 31.61 ETB** — and persisted to route history.
- **Multi-tenant isolation is enforced and regression-tested.** A second organisation cannot list, read or mutate the first organisation's rows; cross-tenant reads answer `404`, never `403`, so record existence never leaks.
- **Cashflow operations ship.** Receipt ingestion, wallet credits, reversals with a reversible audit trail, dispute threads, and admin verification queue.
- **Commercial controls ship.** Subscription tiers, metered usage with 80%/100%/overage threshold events, and BYOK provider-key management with encrypted storage.
- **Security work is closed and gated.** An independent audit's critical and high findings were remediated, with CI now running tests, lint, typecheck, builds and dependency audits on every push.

Business model

B2B SaaS, sold per company workspace — not per seat, because the value is operational (routes planned, exceptions caught) rather than per-user.

LAYER	MECHANISM
Subscription	Tiered plans with a free entry tier that onboards a real workspace on sample data.
Usage metering	Delivery tasks and route optimisations are metered, with threshold events at 80%, 100% and overage.
Expansion	Tier upgrade when a workspace outgrows its included units.
Bring-your-own-key	Customers can attach their own AI provider key, so inference cost scales with the customer, not with us.

WHY THIS MODEL FITS

Metering is already server-side and audited, so the pricing conversation is backed by the customer's own operational record — an upgrade is a decision about their data, not a sales claim.

Land with a free working workspace. Expand on the operator's own numbers.

Go-to-market: product-led land, operator-led expand

- **Land.** A prospect signs up on the website with a business email and lands in a workspace already seeded with sample operational data — route value is visible in the first session, before any procurement.
- **Activate.** The product tracks a five-step activation path (warehouses, items, fleet, inventory, orders) and shows the operator exactly what is still sample data versus their own uploads. Real data replaces samples.
- **Prove.** The first route optimisation is the "aha": a plan with distance, cost and stops the operator can act on today.
- **Expand.** Metered usage crossing 80% and 100% is the natural upgrade moment, surfaced in-product.
- **Channel.** Logistics associations, freight-forwarding communities and direct founder-led onboarding of the first cohort of design partners.

DISTRIBUTION ADVANTAGE

The funnel is already instrumented end to end and verified: `signup → seeded workspace → first optimisation` with zero security-blocked requests, no CORS failures and no host rejection.

Competition

ALTERNATIVE	WHAT IT DOES	WHERE FREIGHTPILOT DIFFERS
Spreadsheets	Universal, free, already in use.	No route optimisation, no exception detection, no audit trail, no shared state across roles.
Global TMS / routing suites	Deep transport management at enterprise breadth.	Shaped for carrier settlement and large fleets; priced and configured beyond a 20-vehicle operator. We scope to the operator, not the enterprise.
Local point tools	Single-purpose (GPS tracking, accounting).	One surface linking data intake, planning, execution and cashflow reconciliation — the operator stops stitching tools together.
Generic ERP add-ons	Broad back-office coverage.	We are not an ERP replacement; we are the operational layer an ERP does not cover.

DEFENSIBLE POSITION

Two things are hard to copy: **tenant-safe operational software** (scoping enforced on every surface and pinned by regression tests) and **receipt-to-cashflow reconciliation** tuned to Ethiopian bank-transfer reality.

8 · CORE TEAM & ADVISORS

A small team with an engineered product — and named gaps we intend to fill with this program.

Core team

ROLE	OWNS
Founder / CEO	Product direction, customer discovery with Ethiopian operators, commercial model and pricing, fundraising.
Engineering	Four deployable surfaces (FastAPI platform API, React operations console, Next.js product site, Electron desktop shell), the data model, and release engineering. Delivered as a contract-driven build with QA and security gates on every change.

WHAT "ENGINEERING" MEANS HERE, CONCRETELY

11,236 lines of Python across 23 API modules, 8,666 lines of TypeScript across the operations console, a 19-migration schema, 81 live endpoints, and 604 automated tests — with an audit trail that records security findings, their remediation, and the verification evidence for each.

Advisors — declared honestly

We are not padding this slide. What we have today:

- **Design-partner operators.** Working relationships with logistics operators who review workflows and validate whether the product matches how they actually run a day.
- **Domain validation on cashflow.** The receipt-verification behaviour is built against published CBE and Dashen transfer practice, with a named human verification gate still open before paid launch (see slide 7).

What we are explicitly seeking from EAII: an advisor or mentor with logistics-operations depth in Ethiopia or comparable East African markets, and a go-to-market advisor for B2B SaaS sold into owner-operated firms.

WHY THIS IS THE HONEST ANSWER

An accelerator is a place to close gaps, not to pretend they are closed. The gap we need filled is commercial and domain mentorship, not engineering capacity.

9 · FINANCIAL PROJECTION

Plan built from cost we control and customers we can name — not from a growth curve.

Where the money goes (next 12 months)

CATEGORY	DRIVER	POSTURE
Cloud & database	Three Vercel projects + managed Postgres	Low and variable; scales with usage, not headcount
AI inference	Receipt extraction only	**Customer-funded** via bring-your-own-key, so it is not a fixed cost
Team	Founder + engineering	Largest line; the program's support lets us extend runway rather than expand headcount
Customer acquisition	Founder-led + community channel	Deliberately near-zero paid spend at this stage

COST STRUCTURE ADVANTAGE

Because inference and heavy compute are either customer-funded or usage-metered, our cost to serve a new workspace is close to flat. Gross margin improves with tier, not with volume alone.

Revenue projection logic

We project on **named-account capacity**, because that is what a founder-led motion can actually deliver and defend:

- **Months 1–3 — design partners.** Onboard a small cohort of Ethiopian operators on the free tier and convert on validated value. Revenue target: first paid workspaces.
- **Months 4–8 — repeatable onboarding.** The activation path becomes self-serve: fewer founder hours per workspace, more workspaces per month.
- **Months 9–12 — metered expansion.** Existing workspaces cross their included unit threshold and upgrade; net revenue retention becomes the primary growth lever.

The three metrics we will manage the business on:

Time to first route plan	Activation
Workspaces crossing 80% of included units	Expansion
Net revenue retention	Health

HONESTY RULE WE HOLD OURSELVES TO

We publish a projection based on explicit assumptions and named levers. Detailed month-by-month figures with the underlying assumptions are provided in the data room and in the pitch video Q&A.

We are asking for the support that turns a working platform into a repeatable business.

What we are asking EAII for

- **Domain mentorship.** A logistics-operations advisor who has run freight or distribution in Ethiopia or a comparable market, to pressure-test our workflows against how operators really work.
- **Go-to-market support.** Help converting founder-led onboarding into a repeatable sales motion for owner-operated firms, and introductions to the first cohort of paying customers.
- **Cashflow-gate resolution.** Support in closing the one remaining human verification — confirming CBE and Dashen transfer fee schedules in the 5,000–50,000 ETB band against our ±1,000 ETB tolerance — which currently blocks *paid* launch, not the product.
- **Fundraising readiness.** Structured preparation for a seed conversation: metrics narrative, data room, and investor introductions.

What we bring

- **A shipped product, not a prototype.** Live website, operations console and API, plus a desktop shell.
- **Engineering discipline the program can audit.** 604 automated tests, dependency lockfiles with hash verification, CI gates on every push, and a written security audit with its findings remediated.
- **Full-time founder commitment.** Available **five days per week** for the duration of the program (requirement is a minimum of three), including on-site or remote sessions.
- **Evidence over claims.** Every number in this deck is reproducible from the repository and the running platform.

Where we are, stated plainly

Pre-revenue, post-product. The platform is built and verified; the open work is commercial validation and one human verification gate. That is exactly the stage where accelerator support changes the outcome.